

Core Rule for Students

For each key section of the proposal, ask:

Claim

What am I saying?



Evidence

What proves or supports it?



Decision

What will I do because of that evidence?

A compelling proposal should reliably demonstrate this reasoning. It's more than just creating a document; it should serve as a documented record of the research and design decisions the student has made, rooted in evidence.

Important: All technical diagrams, including system overviews, must be in black and white and should not be created with AI

Project Title
Individual Component Title

Project ID

Project Proposal Report

Student name – Student ID

B.Sc. (Hons) Degree in Information Technology Specialized in
Specialization

Department of **Department Name**

Sri Lanka Institute of Information Technology Sri Lanka

September 2026

DECLARATION

I declare that this is my own work, and this proposal does not knowingly incorporate any material previously submitted for a degree or diploma at any other university or higher education institution, nor does it contain any material that has been previously published or written by another person apart from where proper acknowledgment is given in the text.

Name	Student ID	Signature

The above candidate is conducting research for their undergraduate Dissertation under my supervision.

Name	Date	Signature

ABSTRACT (Maximum 300 words)

- The abstract should summarize:
 - real-world problem;
 - individual research problem;
 - key evidence supporting the problem;
 - identified gap;
 - proposed research contribution;
 - proposed product component;
 - research methodology;
 - development approach;
 - evaluation method;
 - role of the component in the complete solution.
- 3–5 Keywords at the end

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background and Context

- Describe the real-world problem
- Who is affected and why it is important
- Statistical evidence (local/global)
- Analysis of Existing Solutions and their limitations
- Ideas for the proposed solution and its parts
- Relevant SDG alignment
- Research cluster alignment

2 Literature Review

In General

- Cite relevant peer-reviewed publications.
- Critically evaluate each publication and explain:
method;
dataset;
context;
findings;
strengths;
limitations.
- **Explain how these findings influence your proposed research.**
- What existing systems or products already attempt to solve this problem?

Evidence

- Provide credible information about each of those products:
functions;
technology;
performance;
users;
limitations.

Explain which limitations of existing products or systems your component will address.

1.3 Research Gap

- This should be one of the strongest sections of the proposal.
- Clearly state what is currently unknown, inadequate, inaccurate, inefficient, or insufficiently addressed?
- As evidence, identify the publications, systems, observations, or other evidence that demonstrate the gap.
- State the specific research gap that the proposed individual component will investigate.
- The student should be able to express the gap in one or two precise sentences.

2. OBJECTIVE

2.1 Main Objective

State one measurable main objective.

2.2 Specific Objectives

- 4–6 measurable objectives
- Aligned with research problem
- Aligned with individual components

3. METHODOLOGY

1. Which research methodology or research design is appropriate?

Justify the choice using:

- nature of the research question;
- type of data;
- experimental requirements;
- relevant literature.

State the selected research methodology.

2. Data / Participants / Experimental Inputs

What data, participants, or experimental inputs are required?

Explain why they are appropriate to the research question.

Clearly state:

data source;
sample;
dataset;
participants;
collection method;
preparation process.

3. Baseline / Benchmark

What should the proposed solution be compared against?

Identify credible baseline approaches or current methods.

Select the baseline or benchmark to be used.

4. Evaluation Metrics

How should success be measured?

Justify why the selected metrics are appropriate.

Specify measurable criteria.

Example:

Metric	Why Relevant	Target / Comparison
Accuracy		
Latency		
SUS score		

5. Validation Strategy

How can you demonstrate that your proposed contribution is valid?

Refer to accepted evaluation practices or relevant research.

Specify how results will be validated.

6. Development Approach

What development approach is appropriate?

Explain why the nature of the product, users, and project justify this approach.

State the selected development approach.

Examples may include:

- Agile;
- Scrum;
- iterative prototyping;
- user-centred design.

4. HIGH-LEVEL SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

Overview of proposed solution and its components

System diagram of components

Highlight the individual component and its parts

Overall Integration

How will the four components form a complete solution?

Identify actual dependencies among components.

State the planned integration method.

Students should not provide detailed descriptions of the other members' components.

The purpose is to demonstrate how their own component connects to the full solution.

Individual Responsibility Boundary

Complete the following table.

Activity / Deliverable	My Responsibility	Shared Responsibility	Other Member
Activity 1	✓		
Activity 2		✓	
Activity 3			Member X

5. USER REQUIREMENTS

- What do users require from the proposed component?

Provide evidence from activities such as:

- a. interviews;
 - b. observation;
 - c. surveys;
 - d. workshops;
 - e. stakeholder discussions;
 - f. design-thinking activities
 - g. domain experts
- Translate the findings into proposed system requirements.

Functional requirements (numbered)

Non-functional requirements (response time; security; usability; reliability; scalability; accessibility.) State measurable or testable non-functional requirements where possible.

6. COMMERCIALIZATION PLAN

- Target market and customer persona
- Value proposition
- Revenue model
- Cost estimation
- Pricing strategy
- Competitive advantage
- Intellectual property considerations

7. BUDGET AND JUSTIFICATION

- Hardware costs
- Software licenses
- Cloud services
- Human effort cost
- Justification for each expense

8. WORK BREAKDOWN STRUCTURE (WBS)

- Task breakdown per member
- Timeline alignment
- Balanced workload distribution

9. GANTT CHART

- The Gantt chart should show:
 - literature work;
 - research design;
 - data preparation;
 - experiments;
 - development;
 - prototype work;
 - testing;
 - integration;
 - evaluation;
 - analysis;
 - report preparation.

10.REFERENCES LIST

- Use IEEE referencing style.
- Every important factual, technical, research, or comparative claim should be supported by an appropriate source.
- Students remain responsible for verifying every reference, including references identified through AI-assisted tools.

11.APPENDICES

Possible appendices include:

- stakeholder interview evidence;
- questionnaire;
- observation notes;
- problem analysis;
- literature comparison;
- requirements elicitation evidence;
- preliminary datasets;
- UI sketches;
- architecture;
- prototype evidence;
- WBS;
- Gantt chart;
- ethics documentation;
- additional experimental plans.

Appendix 2 — Mandatory Proposal Evidence and Decision Log

Each student should maintain the following log throughout proposal development.

Date	Claim / Problem	Evidence Collected	Alternatives Considered	Decision Made	Supervisor Discussion

The proposal should be consistent with this log.

Appendix 3 — AI Use Disclosure

Students should disclose any use of generative AI tools during proposal preparation.

AI Tool	Purpose of Use	What Was Generated/Assisted	How Output Was Verified	Final Student Contribution

The use of AI does not transfer responsibility for the submitted work. The student remains responsible for:

- accuracy;
- originality;
- validity of references;
- research decisions;
- methodology;
- technical choices;
- interpretation of evidence;
- and the ability to defend every part of the proposal.